in New Delhi is likely to make significant territorial adjustments.[18] Third and finally, India will have to fashion a new political compact with the disaffected segments of the Kashmiri populace. There is little question that Pakistan has played a significant role in stirring and sustaining discontent within Indian-controlled Kashmir.[19] But it is equally true that flawed Indian policies and political choices helped precipitate the ethnoreligious insurgency that has wracked the state since 1989.[20]

What role are nuclear weapons likely to play in the evolution of this relationship? They are likely to contain the prospects of full-scale war. Crises and tensions may yet characterize Indo-Pakistani relations as long as the Pakistani state remains unhappy with the territorial status quo in Kashmir. However, as multiple crises from 1987 onward have demonstrated, neither side has been willing to expand the scope of various conflicts. Despite the existence of strong domestic sentiments, the presence of a jingoistic political party at the helm of power, and the existence of substantial military capabilities, India chose not to expand the scope of the 1999 Kargil war. Furthermore, in the 2001–2002 crisis, despite grave provocation, India limited itself to the exercise of coercive diplomacy. In the aftermath of the horrific terrorist attacks of November 2008, when incontrovertible evidence linked the terrorists to Pakistan, India embarked on a diplomatic campaign to isolate the Pakistani state but eschewed any risky or provocative military maneuvers.[21] Just as nuclear weapons capped the escalatory process in all these crises, they are likely to do so in future confrontations.

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A number of observers suggest that recent improvements in Kashmir, and in broader Indo-Pakistani relations, have resulted from the pacifying effects of nuclear deterrence. V. R. Raghavan, for example, argues that “a peace process with Pakistan on Kashmir has commenced and will continue. The conflict stabilization and the future resolution of the dispute could well be attributed to deterrence operating in the region.”[22] In truth, however, improvements in Indo-